

A similar theme was heard from a Long Island native who writes the blog *Freedom is Groovy*. He said he and his wife were drifting through life without paying attention to their spending. Once they started tracking spending, they realized they were spending \$800 each month to feed two people. Armed with that fact, they were able to cut the cost in half quickly.

Brad and his wife Laura set a goal of feeding their family of four for \$2 per person per meal. They utilize a combination of limiting restaurant meals, meal planning, and shopping strategically. This not only allows them to eat well for little money, but it also improves their lives by increasing efficiency.

Brad

My wife Laura's meal planning has been one of the main keys to our success not only with our finances but with our health as well.

Laura loves to cook and experiment with new meals. She's always looking to optimize her meal planning to save time, money, and stress. She looks for great deals on items in bulk that she can have at the ready. For instance, she buys the "family pack" of chicken cutlets, which is normally 5+ pounds.